

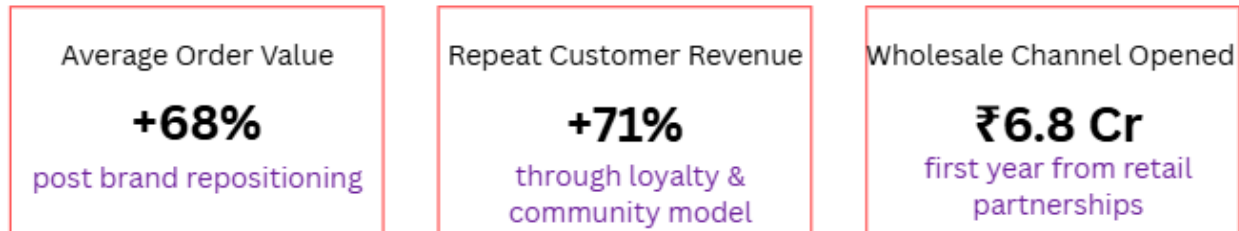


Case Study · Fashion & Beauty · Brand & Commercial Strategy

Beautiful product.

Business that finally matches it.

How an independent fashion and beauty label stopped competing on price, built a brand with staying power, and created a revenue model that didn't depend on the next collection — with **Stralchemistry**.



BACKGROUND

An independent fashion and beauty label built around sustainable, artisan-crafted products had developed a genuine following — a community of customers who believed in the brand's ethos and returned enthusiastically for each new collection. The founders had creative credibility, a distinctive aesthetic, and a product quality that outclassed competitors at the same price point. But the business model was dangerously collection-dependent: revenue spiked at launch and evaporated between drops. Margins were thin from heavy discounting used to clear slow-moving inventory, and the brand's premium potential was being systematically undercut by its own pricing behavior.

Stralchemistry was brought in to align the commercial model with the quality the brand had already earned.

PAINPOINTS

Four commercial patterns were quietly eroding a brand with genuine premium potential:

Discount culture undermining brand equity

End-of-season sales and flash discount campaigns had trained the customer to wait for markdowns. Full-price sell-through rates had dropped below 45% - and the brand was teaching its audience that its products were not worth the original price.

Revenue living and dying by launches

Seventy percent of annual revenue was generated in the two weeks around collection launches. Between drops, the business had no revenue engine - leaving a foundation team managing a feast-or-famine cash flow cycle with no predictability.

Community strength, commercial weakness

The brand had a genuinely engaged audience, characterized by high open rates, strong social interaction, and a loyal core. But there was no monetization architecture around that community beyond selling them the next product. The relationship was being underutilized at every stage.

Wholesale entirely absent

The brand's quality and aesthetic were well-suited for premium multi-brand retail - concept stores, curated boutiques, lifestyle destinations. None had been approached. A high-margin distribution channel with strong brand-building value was going completely unexplored.

THE STRALCHEMY ENGAGEMENT

Stralchemy ran a focused 10-week strategy engagement spanning brand positioning, revenue architecture, community monetisation, and wholesale channel development. The founding team's creative instincts were treated as an asset throughout — the goal was to build commercial rigour around them, not replace them.

1. Pricing and Positioning Reset

Stralchemy facilitated a brand value audit that quantified the gap between the product's quality and its market positioning. A structured move upmarket was designed — price corrections phased across two collections, a discount moratorium replacing sale events with exclusive early-access for loyal customers, and a revised product narrative centred on craft and longevity rather than trend and novelty. Full-price sell-through climbed from 45% to 79% within two collections.

2. Revenue Smoothing Between Launches

Stralchemy designed three inter-collection revenue streams — a made-to-order programme for hero pieces, a curated archive sale replacing ad-hoc discounting, and a subscription box model for the beauty range offering recurring monthly revenue independent of the fashion calendar. Revenue between launches grew from near-zero to 30% of monthly totals within six months.

3. Community Monetization Framework

The brand's loyal audience was mapped across three tiers — casual followers, engaged customers, and brand advocates. A structured programme was built for each: content-led nurturing for the first, an early-access membership for the second, and a co-creation and ambassador programme for the third. Community became a commercial asset rather than a vanity metric.

4. Wholesale Entry Strategy

Stralchemy built a wholesale proposition — a curated line selection, a trade pricing structure, and a target retail partner list of 40 premium multi-brand stores across metro India and select international markets. An outreach and pitch process was designed and run with the founding team. Eight retail partnerships were signed in the first six months; the channel generated ₹6.8Cr in its first full year.

OUTCOMES

A brand that commands its price

Full-price sell-through rose from 45% to 79%. Average order value grew 68% as customers - no longer conditioned to wait for discounts - began buying at launch, at full price, with conviction.

Revenue between the drops

Inter-collection revenue streams contributed 30% of monthly revenue within six months. A predictable baseline replaced the feast-or-famine cash flow cycle the team could plan around.

Community converted to customers

The early-access membership enrolled 1,800 customers in its first cycle. Repeat customer revenue grew 71% - driven by a community that now had structured reasons to stay engaged between collections.

Wholesale channel live and scaling

Eight premium retail partnerships generated ₹6.8Cr in year one. The wholesale channel also elevated brand perception - being stocked in curated boutiques reinforced the premium positioning the brand was building online.

“We were so focused on making beautiful things that we never stopped to ask if we were building a beautiful business. **Stralchemistry** asked that question - and then helped us answer it.”

Creative Director & Co-Founder, Independent Fashion & Beauty Label
(Identity withheld at client request)

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